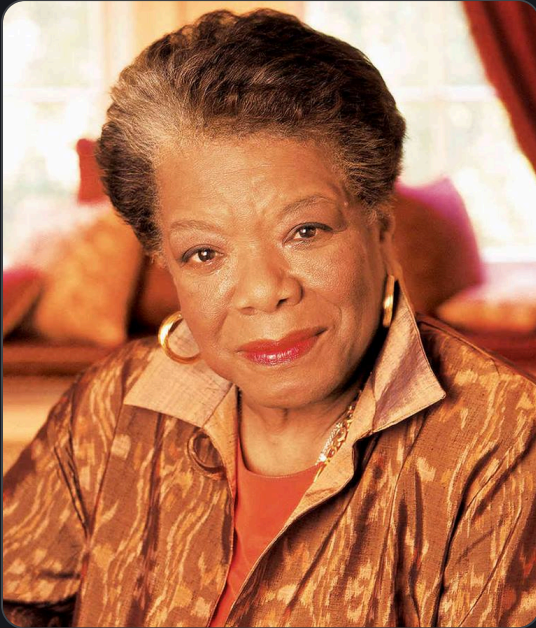


Work backwards from the smile.

Start with the experience. Follow it all the way back, and see what you end up with.



What most gets in the way
of delivering a great
customer experience at
your company?



“I’ve learned that people will forget what you said, people will forget what you did, but people will never forget **how you made them feel.**”

Maya Angelou

01 / WHERE IT STARTS

You want loyal customers
who **refer you to their friends.**



FEELING IS NOT THE SOFT SIDE

73%

say experience is an
important factor in
what they buy

32%

walk away from a brand
they love after one bad
experience

PwC, Future of Customer Experience, 2018





A NORTH STAR, IN THE WILD

**“Every guest leaves
with a smile.”**

One sentence. It fell out of him while he was talking about what he actually wanted the restaurant to be.

Masuko, 4P's CEO



SAME JOB, DIFFERENT SCALE

NORTH STAR

Sets the direction in the moment.

One sentence that defines the experience your team delivers. Every interaction, every day.

VISION & MISSION

Sets the direction for the long term.

Where the company is going and why it exists.
However far out that is, is yours to choose.

Vision and Mission will not help the person standing in front of an unhappy customer right now. **That is the job the North Star was built for.**



02 / YOUR TURN

Now do it for *your company*.



HOLD IT IN YOUR HEAD FOR A SECOND

Maybe you already have one of these.
Maybe you have never written it down.

Either way, picture the experience
that makes **your** customer come
back and bring someone with them.

Got it.



Good.

I need a volunteer.



1 What experience do you want your customers to have?



WHAT YOU JUST DESCRIBED

That is your **North Star**.

One sentence that defines the experience your team delivers, every interaction, every day.

You can feel it

You can act on it



2 How would your people have to **behave**, every day, for your customer to get that?



WHAT YOU JUST DESCRIBED

**Those behaviours
are your values.**

Not the words on the wall. The things everyone is expected to do, every day, without being asked.

**You just wrote a culture.
Backwards, from the customer.**



3 How do you get them to
behave that way
reliably? Not on a good
day. **Every day.**



THERE IS ONLY ONE ANSWER, AND IT IS ALWAYS THE SAME

Systems.

Who you hire

How you onboard

How you train

How you meet

What and when you recognise

What you measure

How you decide

Values are a tool. A tool has no power on its own. The system is the behaviour around the tool.



WHERE MOST COMPANIES LOSE IT

They hand culture to HR and change nothing about how the work gets done.

Most systems on that list belong to operations. Built properly, your culture is a strategic element of the business, not a programme running beside it.



SAME LIST, SORTED BY WHO ACTUALLY RUNS IT

Systems.

HR

Crickets.

HR + OPERATIONS

Who you hire

How you onboard

How you train

What and when you recognise

OPERATIONS

How you meet

What you measure

How you decide



03 / DO THIS ON MONDAY

Three questions. Fifteen minutes. A whiteboard.

It works on your team, your board, and the person who thinks none of this is their job. Ask in order, let them answer, and they build the case themselves in their own words.



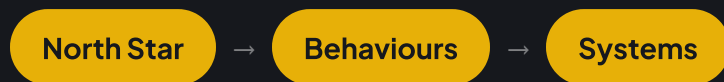
TAKE A PHOTO OF THIS ONE

- 1 What experience do you want your customers to have?
- 2 How would your people have to **behave**, every day, for your customer to get that?
- 3 How do you get them to behave that way reliably? Not on a good day. **Every day.**

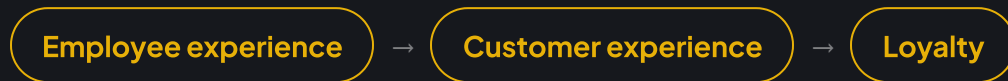


WHERE EX AND CX STOP BEING TWO DEPARTMENTS

WHAT YOU BUILD



WHAT YOU GET



This is the **Symphony of Experience.**

An audience hears two hours. The performance was made in the hundreds of hours nobody watched.



AND YES, THAT IS A LOT OF WORK

**Culture, skills, systems,
motivation. Miss one and the
picture never completes.**

There is a word for the completed picture, and it has been measured for twenty years.



Engagement.

TOP QUARTILE VERSUS BOTTOM QUARTILE

+23%

profitability

+10%

customer loyalty

Gallup Q12 meta-analysis, 11th edition, 2024



nobody owns cx no systemic change
no proof for bosses leadership vs customer
fast with few resources
data, no action cx roi unproven
customer change factor

What most gets in the way of delivering a great customer experience at your company? **8 answers**

ADD YOURS



ONE THING ABOUT THAT LIST

**Every word on it came from
someone in this room.**

**Not one came from the
people doing the work.**

Solve that list and you may fix nothing at all.



Ask the people who live inside the systems you just designed.

Not a 60-question annual survey nobody reads. A short one, in their own language, where every free-text answer is read and classified rather than counted.

Under 5 minutes

Any language

Anonymised

Answers in days, not months

Show the actions taken



ONE LAST THING

Don't make this a big deal.

Treat it as a project and it gets scoped, staffed and postponed. Keep it simple. Ask your people what gets in the way, and let them tell you what to fix first.

**Build a better place to work and you build
a better company to be a customer of.**

If you want help with any of it, come find me.



Dreamscape

Thank you to XMGlobal Collaborative



**Everything works
better if people
love what they do.**

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dreamscope.win



Over to the panel